THE GREEN CRUSADER

From receiving an award for her efforts on wildlife conservation to championing environmental cinema, actress-activist **Dia Mirza** is making a difference

Q. You were conferred with the Wildlife Advocate of the Year award at the prestigious IFAW Animal Action Awards this year. How does it feel?

As an ambassador of the Wildlife Trust of India, I have had the good fortune to learn, travel extensively and engage with wildlife and people who work on-ground. It has also helped me understand the daily struggles faced by forest guards in the line of duty. I consider it a privilege to be able to celebrate the upholders of these natural ecosystems and pay a tribute to their courage through my work.

Q. There's also your appointment to the jury of the All Living Things Environmental Film Festival (ALT EFF). Do you believe a platform like this can inspire change?

The need of the hour in conservation and climate action is change in human behaviour. What better instrument than the power of compelling stories to change hearts and evoke one's conscience? It's been such a privilege to witness the whole spectrum of storytelling at ALT EFF.

Q. Your recent appearance as showstopper for Samant Chauhan at the Lakme Fashion Week in Delhi was much talked about.

It's again a powerful example of how a person (Chauhan) from Bhagalpur, Bihar—known for its textiles—has stayed true to his roots. He has done everything within his means to empower his grassroots weavers and his brand philosophy and work ethic are fantastic. I enjoyed wearing his garments and celebrating his work and legacy.

Q. What's next on the cards?

There's lots of exciting things happening. I find myself in a sweet spot where purpose meets passion. I have signed two projects, one of which is complete but I can't speak about it at the moment.

—with Geetika Sachdev



Photograph by **MANDAR DEODHAR**